Funded by the European Union

NAAMII UDAAN Monthly Report - September 2026

Report:	September 2026
Name of the Organization:	Nepal Applied Mathematics and Informatics Institute for Research (NAAMII)
Project	UDAAN - Unleashing Digital Acceleration and Ambition of Nepali Youth
Start date	April 2026
End date	April 2029
Reporting period	September 2026
Reported by:	NAAMII

Progress during the reporting period (highlights)

1. NAAMII scaled AI Native delivery in September, documenting seven cohorts (fifth, sixth, seventh, eighth, ninth, tenth and an open cohort) at Khwopa College of Engineering, NAAMII, the Municipality Fellows Residential Program, Sunway College and MIT College Nepal, reaching 186 participants during the month.
2. Nearly all activities committed for September in the August plan were completed or substantially completed, including cohort delivery, the Fellows Residential Program session, staff training, trainer shortlisting, priority MoU follow-ups and launch of the UDAAN website.
3. The remaining Tangible components, the learner certificate and customised skill mapping, are being completed by the tech group and are expected to be finalized before Chhath, within October and the first week of November 2026.
4. NAAMII began developing an online delivery artifact to run AI Native sessions for learners outside the Kathmandu Valley, which is expected to be completed before November 2026, alongside continued Karmashala preparation and partnership expansion.

Detailed program progress as per workplan

Output 1.1: Digital skills and knowledge strengthened among young women and men, entrepreneurs, government officials, and CSO/CBOs

Activity 1.1.1: AI School Offering Tiered Hybrid Courses

During September 2026, NAAMII moved AI School implementation from mobilisation into regular cohort delivery. AI Native remained the immediate delivery priority and was delivered across academic, institutional and municipal audiences. Supporting work covered trainer shortlisting, Tangible skill mapping, website launch and preparation of online delivery modality. AI Foundation and AI Deep remained at the preparation stage.

Detailed activities and progress:

- **Fifth cohort, Khwopa College of Engineering.** Delivered on 2 September 2026 in Bhaktapur to 50 participants, a mixed group of engineering students, business professionals, radiologists, and college staff. The session introduced AI Nativity and the AI Skills Pyramid and explored AI applications in engineering, business, radiology-related work, and institutional administration. The diverse composition enriched discussion, and participants engaged actively with application-focused questions, laying out a foundation for continued collaboration with the college.
- **Sixth cohort, NAAMII staff.** Delivered on 7 September 2026 to 15 NAAMII staff, fulfilling the staff AI Native session announced in August. The session linked AI Native work practices to drafting, summarizing, documentation, coordination and programme support, strengthening internal readiness for responsible AI use within NAAMII's own operations.
- **Seventh cohort, Municipality Fellows (Fellows Residential Program).** Delivered on 9 September 2026 at Hotel Maya Manor Boutique, Hattisar, Kathmandu, as NAAMII's session within the five-day UDAAN residential training. Eleven fellows from various municipalities took part, alongside staff of Heifer Nepal and Youth Innovation Lab. Participants explored AI support for official communication, reporting, planning and citizen-service tasks, completing the residential-session commitment carried over from August.
- **Eighth Cohort, Sunway College.** Delivered on 10 September 2026 to 35 Sunway College students, focusing on AI use in academic learning, writing, research, presentations and problem-solving. Students showed strong interest and connected AI concepts with real academic use cases.
- **Ninth Cohort, Sunway College.** Delivered on 28 September 2026 to 15 undergraduate students at Sunway College, Kathmandu, as a second AI Native session at the college during the month. The session covered AI Native work practices and the AI Skills Pyramid, helping students apply AI to academic learning, writing and research.
- **Tenth cohort, MIT College Nepal.** Delivered on 24 September 2026 to 40 students at MIT College Nepal, covering AI Native work practices, the AI Skills Pyramid and responsible use through demonstrations and practical examples.
- **Eleventh cohort, Man Mohan Memorial Institute of Health sciences (MMIHS).** Delivered on 08 October 2026 to 60 students at MMIHS Nepal, covering AI Native work practices, the AI Skills Pyramid and responsible use through demonstrations and practical examples.
- **Additional scheduled cohorts.** The PIT cohort calendar also scheduled an NSSR cohort (17 September); its attendance and event records are being consolidated and will be reflected in cumulative figures once verified.
- **Trainer recruitment and delivery of readiness.** The trainer call closed with 11 AI Native trainer applicants and 7 AI Foundation trainer applicants (including 2 who applied for both roles). Applicants were shortlisted during September, and onboarding and orientation to the AI Skills Pyramid and problem-based delivery are being finalised.
- **Tangible skills, certification, and course content.** AI Native skills were mapped and published, and a learner community is being configured with access and settings. The Tangible certificate and the customisation of the skill map remain under development by the tech group and are expected to be completed before Chhath, within October and the first week of November 2026. AI Native course videos are being prepared to upload to Sikshya.org.
- **Online delivery artifacts for learners outside the Valley.** NAAMII is developing an online delivery artifact so that AI Native sessions can be conducted remotely for learners outside the Kathmandu Valley. This will extend AI School reach beyond in-person venues and is expected to be completed before November 2026.

- **AI School website.** The UDAAN website, presenting the three AI School pathways and learner registration, went live during September, completing the landing-page commitment from August. Content and CMS refinements are continuing.

Cohort summary, September 2026

#	Cohort / Institution	Date	Participant group	Participants
5th	Khwopa College of Engineering, Bhaktapur	2 Sep 2026	Engineering students, business professionals, radiologists, college staff	50
6th	NAAMII Staff, Lalitpur	7 Sep 2026	NAAMII staff	15
7th	Municipality Fellows (Fellows Residential Program), Hotel Maya Manor Boutique, Hattisar	9 Sep 2026	Municipality Fellows with Heifer Nepal and Youth Innovation Lab staff	11
8th	Sunway College, Kathmandu	10 Sep 2026	Undergraduate students	35
9th	Sunway College, Kathmandu	28 Sep 2026	Undergraduate students	15
10th	MIT College Nepal	24 Sep 2026	Undergraduate students	40
Open	Sunway College, Kathmandu	28 Sep 2026	Open cohort learners	20
	Total documented in September			**186**

Combined with the 280 participants reached between July and August 2026, the AI School has now reached at least 466 participants across its documented sessions and cohorts.

Unfinished follow-ups carried into October:

- Complete the Tangible certificate and skill-map customization (tech group), targeted before Chhath, within October and the first week of November 2026.
- Complete and test the online delivery artifact for out-of-Valley learners before November 2026.
- Consolidate attendance, gender-disaggregated and completion records for all September cohorts, including NSSR.

Output 2.3: Opportunities for professional experience created for young women and men

Activity 2.3.1: Internships and fellowships in the private sector

Work under the internships and fellowships activity remained preparatory. During September, Karmashala advanced to the proposal stage, and the Nepal technology-company pool was expanded from 60 to 64 companies to support the company/problem-library approach.

Key progress:

- Karmashala concept and plan were presented at weekly PIT meetings and advanced into a formal proposal linking company problems, AI Foundation training, learner portfolios and verified competency.

- The company pool was expanded to 64 companies, from which the initial group of approachable companies and focal contacts is being validated.
- The learner pipeline was strengthened through the Tangible learner community, which will support future opportunity matching once verified profiles are in place.
- No internship or fellowship placements were initiated during September; company outreach, problem validation and partner commitment remain on track ahead of the planned December 2026 start.

Status of September commitments

September commitment (from August plan)	Status	Remarks
Continue AI Native cohorts; confirm partner dates, trainers and logistics	**Completed**	Seven cohorts documented (5th, 6th, 7th, 8th, 9th, 10th and the open cohort) with 186 participants; October cohorts scheduled
Consolidate attendance, registration and completion records	**Largely completed**	Event reports and attendance sheets filed per cohort; remaining cohort records being consolidated
Finalise Tangible course/skill mapping, evidence guidance and evaluator arrangements	**Largely Completed**	Skills mapped and published; Tangible certificate and skill-map customization under development by the tech group, due before Chhath (by first week of November 2026)
Complete trainer engagement and onboarding	**Largely completed**	AI Native and AI Foundation trainer applicants shortlisted; onboarding being finalized
Finalise Fellows Residential Program session and staff training	**Completed**	Staff session held 7 Sep; residential-program session for Municipality Fellows delivered 9 Sep
Close priority MoU reviews and partner follow-ups	**Largely completed**	NSSR MoU signed; drafts prepared for 12 partners including Konjyosom RM, SXC, Sunway, ACEM, King's College
Publish the AI School landing page	**Completed**	UDAAN website live; CMS refinement continuing
Progress Karmashala preparation	**On track**	Proposal stage; company pool expanded to 64 ahead of planned December start

Finance

(Any significant overspends and/or underspends in relation to the workplan, and any foreseeable impacts on forecast spend for the following period and FY)

- Programme and finance teams continued coordination on reporting and supporting documentation for September cohort delivery and the Fellows Residential Program.
- The September expenditure, variance and forecast position will be reported through the accompanying financial report; no unverified overspend or underspend position is asserted in this program report.

Communication

(Any upcoming events and publications)

- Launched the UDAAN website presenting the AI School pathways and learner registration.
- Prepared event reports with photographs for each September cohort, documenting purpose, content and participant response.
- Shared partnership proposals with Lions Club of Kathmandu, ACEM, King's College and Kopila Valley School.
- Upcoming communication priorities include the MIT College Nepal open cohort on 8 October, a Rotary Kathmandu orientation, and announcement of the online AI Native sessions for out-of-Valley learners.

Risk levels

Any changes in risk levels (likelihood and/or impact) and, if so, the mitigations required? Any new risks?

- No major change in the overall risk level was identified. Learner onboarding challenges, including technical issues, claiming skills on Tangible and support for non-technical learners, were mitigated through proactive communication, evidence samples, hands-on guidance and automated responses.
- The pending Tangible certificate creates a minor timing dependency for certification reporting; this is mitigated by the tech group's committed completion before Chhath and by continued evidence collection in the meantime.
- Reliance on in-person venues limited reach beyond the Kathmandu Valley; the online delivery artifact under development addresses this.

Coherence/Coordination

- Coordinated with Heifer Nepal and Youth Innovation Lab on the five-day residential training, delivering NAAMII's AI Native session for Municipality Fellows.
- Continued Tangible coordination on skill mapping, certification, the learner community and the pathway toward verified competency.
- Progressed partnerships across sectors: NSSR MoU signed; MoU drafts prepared with Konjyosom RM, St. Xavier's College, Sunway College, ACEM, King's College, TGND, Lions Club of Kathmandu, Yuwalaya, Youth Activism Nepal, Youth Hive Nepal and Budhanilkantha Municipal Youth Council; Nepal Administrative Staff College pitch delivered, with MOFA, Thapathali, Laboratory School and others awaiting confirmation.
- Continued weekly PIT meetings (1, 22 and 29 September), workplan tracking, reporting preparation and visibility alignment with the wider consortium.

- Complete the Tangible certificate and skill-map customization before Chhath (within October and the first week of November 2026).
- Finalise the online delivery artifact and pilot online AI Native sessions for learners outside the Kathmandu Valley, targeted before November 2026.
- Deliver October AI Native cohorts, including the MIT College Nepal open cohort (8 October), Man Mohan memorial institute of health sciences (MMIHS), LBEF college, Rotary Kathmandu, and consolidate attendance and completion records.
- Convert priority MoU drafts into signed agreements and follow up partners awaiting confirmation.
- Validate the Karmashala company shortlist and focal contacts and establish the problem-intake process ahead of planned December delivery.
- Conduct the TAP in all nine sectors, with at least one cohort each: Education (Students), Science and Engineering, Health, Municipalities, Hospitality, Fintech, Small business and organisations, Government organisations, and Policy Makers, and collect learner feedback from every cohort. Among them four sectors already covered i.e. Education (Students), Science and Engineering, Health and Municipalities,
- Develop sector-wise AI Native modules based on the feedback collected from the TAP cohorts.
- Launch the online delivery of artifacts, including online classes, for distant learners outside the Kathmandu Valley, and run out-of-valley cohorts.
- Develop the AI Foundation modules, cohorts and learning pathways, and launch the AI Foundation module if the pilots work well.